

Natural Vegetation and Wildlife

- India is rich in biodiversity and is among the 12 megabiodiversity countries in the world.
- 4700 species of plant, and ranks 10th in the world in terms of diversity.
- 15000 species → ~~Flaming~~ Flowering plant.
- 90,000 species present in India.
- Natural Vegetation: It refers to plant community which has grown naturally without any human disturbance and is left undisturbed.
- ⇒ Wildlife: All the wild animals living in their natural environment.
- ⇒ Species may be:
 - 1) Indigenous Species.
 - Also called as native species.

- That naturally occur in a particular region or area, e.g. Bengal Tiger, Neam.

2) Exotic Species: Those species which are introduced from another area.

e.g. Cantara Camora.

3) Endemic Species: That are present in a particular geographical location.

e.g. Hangul. (J&K).

→ Flora: Species of plants are collectively called as flora.

→ Fauna: Species of animals are collectively c/a Fauna.

⇒ Types of Vegetation:

1) Tropical Evergreen forest.

2) Tropical deciduous forest.

3) Tropical thorn forest or scrubs.

4) ~~Mon~~ Mountain forest.

5) Mangrove forest.

1) Tropical Evergreen Forest

⇒ Location: Present in the areas of Western Ghats, Islands of Andaman and Nicobar, Upper parts of Assam and T.N. Coast.

→ They flourish in area where rainfall is high. (more than 200 cm).

→ Characteristics: Height of trees is high (600 m or more).

→ They do not shed their leaves, thus forest remains green throughout the year.

→ It has all kinds of trees, shrubs, creepers, etc.

Thus multi-layered structure.

→ Commercially imp. Trees - Ebony, ~~At~~ Mahogany,

Rubber, Rosewood, Cinchona.

→ Animals - Elephant, Monkey, Horned rhino (Assam W.B.)